

Let's ^{SOLVE}  it

Student Participation Agreement for the RBC Borealis Undergraduate Mentorship Program



Spring 2026

Please return this agreement signed by you by March 20, 2026.

The undersigned students (each individually referred to as “I” or “me”), in consideration of the information and expertise made available to me in connection with my participation in the RBC Borealis Undergraduate Mentorship Program (the “**Program**” or “**Let’s Solve It**”) provided by the Royal Bank of Canada (the “**Bank**”) and CNIB - The Canadian National Institute for the Blind (the “**Company**”), and other valuable consideration, agree to abide by the terms set out in this Student Participation Agreement for the RBC Borealis Undergraduate Mentorship Program (the “**Agreement**”), including but not limited to the following:

1. Status

I hereby acknowledge that I am currently an undergraduate student enrolled in a Bachelor’s program at a Canadian university.

2. Project Proposal

I acknowledge and agree that my participation in this Program is based on the project proposal that has been prepared by the Company and attached to this Agreement (the “**Project**”) and I agree to adhere to this Project. I agree not to change my Project without first consulting with my RBC Borealis and Company mentor.

3. Team Participation

I acknowledge and agree that the Program is team oriented and I will be working with team members to complete my Project. I agree that it is my team’s responsibility to manage its members’ workload and I acknowledge that the Bank and the Company will not assist in managing team members’ participation and contributions.

4. Time Commitment

I agree to dedicate 10 hours each week to my Project between Mar 16 - May 31, 2026, including at least one 1 hour team meeting and one 30 min meeting with my RBC Borealis and/or Company mentor(s) each week. I also agree to attend and participate in any workshops presented during the two months of the Program. I acknowledge that upon completion of the Program on May 31, 2026, the Program will terminate.

5. Project Outputs

I acknowledge and agree that I am required to provide the following outputs by the end of the Program:

- *A presentation.* A 15 minutes talk/slide presentation to the RBC Borealis and/or Company team and other guests, outlining the work undertaken and the proposed path forward for my Project.
- *A one-page summary.* A short summary of the presentation.
- *Sharing code.* Students shall share any tests or proof of concepts from the Project with the Bank and the Company.
- *A blog post and/or public presentation (Optional).* If my team is selected, I will work with RBC Borealis to write a short blog and/or produce a short public presentation about my experience in the Program and Project outcomes. I understand this may require my participation beyond the end of the Program.
- *A white paper (Optional).* An expanded, formal treatment of the Project with a precise plan for how machine learning can be used to help with the problem outlined and what work is required to make the solution a reality. I understand this may require my participation beyond the end of the Program.
- *A research publication (Optional).* If my team is interested in producing a research publication from the work generated from the Program I will notify RBC Borealis prior to completion of the Program. I agree to include all the RBC Borealis mentors as co-authors in any such research publication and I understand this may require my participation beyond the end of the Program.

6. In-person Attendance

I acknowledge that:

- a. If I am resident in the city of Toronto, Vancouver, Waterloo, Montreal or Calgary, I may be expected to attend at least one in-person meeting at the RBC Borealis office in my city of residence. Travel costs for attending such in-person meetings will not be reimbursed.
- b. A presentation day may be held at the end of the Program at the Toronto, Vancouver and Montreal RBC Borealis offices. If I am resident within a 3-hour commutable distance from the city that will host an in-person presentation day, I am expected to attend the presentation day in-person to present my team's presentation. If I will be travelling from outside the Greater Toronto Area, Greater Vancouver or Greater Montreal, I may request reimbursement of reasonable travel expenses up to a maximum of \$50 Canadian Dollars. Reimbursement of travel expenses is at the sole discretion of the Bank. Any request for reimbursement must be submitted for pre-approval by the Bank at least 5 business days in advance of the presentation day.

If I have any concerns about my ability to attend in person, I will immediately discuss this with my RBC Borealis and/or Company mentor to consider whether any alternate options are available.

7. Intellectual Property

- a. Definitions:
 - i. **"Intellectual Property"** means all inventions, ideas, prototypes, improvements, modifications and/or discoveries, know-how, methods, procedures or techniques, patents and patent applications, registered and unregistered trademarks, copyright, including but not limited to mask works, computer software, both object and source code, data, data bases and works of authorship, all the foregoing whether registrable or not and all right, title and interest therein; and

- ii. **“Project Results”** means all Intellectual Property or products that I first create, identify, or reduce to practice or writing, whether solely or jointly with others, directly in performance of the Project.
- b. I will disclose to my RBC Borealis and/or Company mentor any Intellectual Property in the Project that was already generated by me or my team members prior to starting the Program (**“Background Intellectual Property”**).
- c. I will avoid use of any Intellectual Property that is personally known to me to be owned by a third party.
- d. I will notify my RBC Borealis and/or Company mentor of any Project Results.
- e. I understand that Intellectual Property created or invented by a party shall remain the property of that party.
- f. I understand that the Bank and Company would like to use my Project Results and in order to ensure that it has the freedom to do so, I agree to the following:
 - i. The Bank may use the Project Results, when describing the Project, as set out in Section 12.
 - ii. The Company may use the Project Results for the purpose of research, education, internal business purposes, and will not otherwise commercialize the Research Results. The Company may not sublicense or otherwise permit any third party to use the Project Results or any rights or interest therein.

8. Project Results

The parties recognize that the Project is experimental and exploratory in nature and no particular results can be guaranteed. Each party acknowledges that the other makes no representation or warranty, either express or implied, with respect to the Project Results and understands that the Project Results are provided “as is”.

9. Disqualifications

I acknowledge that my Project may be disqualified from the Program if the Company and/or Bank has reason to believe, in the Company's and/or Bank's sole discretion, that my Project (a) contains any element that is malicious, corrupt, damaged, incomplete, inappropriate, or offensive; (b) violates the terms of use of any social media service, website, mobile application or any other platform used in connection with your Project; (c) infringes any third party Intellectual Property rights; (d) violates any applicable law; or (e) violates or does not comply with any section of this Agreement.

I acknowledge that I and/or my entire team may be disqualified from the Program for any of the following actions, with or without warning, in the Company's and/or Bank's sole discretion: (i) verbal abuse of another participant or Program staff/mentor; (ii) breach of this Agreement or any other agreement entered into in connection with the Program; (iii) use of Bank or Company resources and/or infrastructure for any purpose other than as approved by the Bank and/or Company, respectively, in connection with the Program; or (iv) violating the spirit of the Program.

All disqualification decisions are final and not subject to appeal.

10. Confidentiality

- a. I will keep all information that is provided to me by the Bank and/or Company (the **"Confidential Information"**) in the strictest confidence and unless I have written consent of the Bank and/or Company, as applicable, to do so, I will not:
 - i. disclose to others, including publishing or including in any of my course work, the Confidential Information; or
 - ii. make any use of such Confidential Information except as required to perform activities directly related to the Project.
- b. For the avoidance of doubt, the following would not be considered Confidential Information and I would not be prevented from disclosing such information when I can establish that such information:

- i. was already known to me at the time of disclosure by the Bank and/or Company;
 - ii. was available to the public or otherwise was part of the public domain at the time of disclosure by the Bank and/or Company; or
 - iii. became available to the public or otherwise became part of the public domain after the time of disclosure by the Bank and/or Company, but other than through my own acts or omissions in violation of this acknowledgement.
- c. I will promptly report any privacy, confidentiality, or security issue involving the Confidential Information to my RBC Borealis and/or Company mentor.
 - d. I will adhere to the Bank's and/or the Company's procedures and instructions, as applicable, regarding the return or destruction of Confidential Information in my possession.

11. Certificate of Completion

Upon completion of the Program, the Bank will present Program participants with a certificate of completion. To receive this certificate, I acknowledge and agree that I must fulfill all the requirements of the Program as set out in this Agreement (including but not limited to attending meetings and workshops, completing weekly Project work, and completing my Project deliverables). The Bank may also present participants with a nominal gift upon completion of the Program. I acknowledge and agree that this gift must be accepted as awarded and will not be transferable, assignable, convertible to cash, or substituted except at the Bank's option.

12. Consent and Release

- a. I hereby authorize the Bank and the Company to announce my participation in the Program by name, describe my Project, and use my photograph, voice, image, likeness, or testimonial (collectively referred to as the “**Personal and Project References**”) on the Bank and the Company website, blog posts, promotion in social

media posts, interviews, videos, celebration gatherings and other promotional activities

- b. The aforementioned promotional material may be combined, modified or edited at the Bank's and the Company's sole discretion for the purposes of producing and distributing materials related to marketing, promotions, advertisements and communications. I hereby agree that the Bank and the Company will have unlimited rights to use and exploit, for any purposes and by any means, the Personal and Project References throughout the world and in perpetuity, in and on any format and through all media, including but not limited to online and in social media.
- c. I hereby grant a full and final release and discharge the Bank and the Company from any loss, liability, claim, damages or cause of action I may have in relation, directly or indirectly, to the Personal and Project References, including any claims based on defamation, invasion of privacy, rights of publicity, moral rights or their likes, or any claims regarding any damages or injuries that could occur during filming, recording or photographing, and for any compensation for the use by the Bank and Company of my Personal and Project References.
- d. I acknowledge that this consent and release is given without monetary consideration and that no amount may be claimed by me, or by any third party representing me, with regard to the use and exploitation of the Personal and Project References.

For Parents or Legal Guardians of Minors (if applicable): I represent that I am the parent or legal guardian of the below-named minor.

13. Counterparts

This Agreement may be executed and delivered in any number of counterparts, including via facsimile or electronic transmission, each of which when executed and delivered will be deemed to be an original but all of which taken together will constitute one and the same instrument.

[SIGNATURE PAGE FOLLOWS]

READ AND ACCEPTED AT _____ THIS DAY _____ OF _____, 2026.

ROYAL BANK OF CANADA

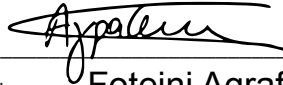
Signature:



Name: **Greg Mori**

Title: **VP, RBC Fellow**

Signature:



Name: **Foteini Agrafioti**

Title: **SVP, Data and AI & Chief Science Officer**

[COMPANY]

Signature:

Name:

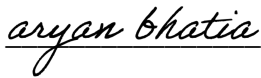
Title:

Signature:

Name:

Title:

Student Signature:



Print Name:

Aryan Bhatia

Address:

15 Dundonald St, Unit 2405, ON M4Y 1K4

Name of Minor (if applicable):